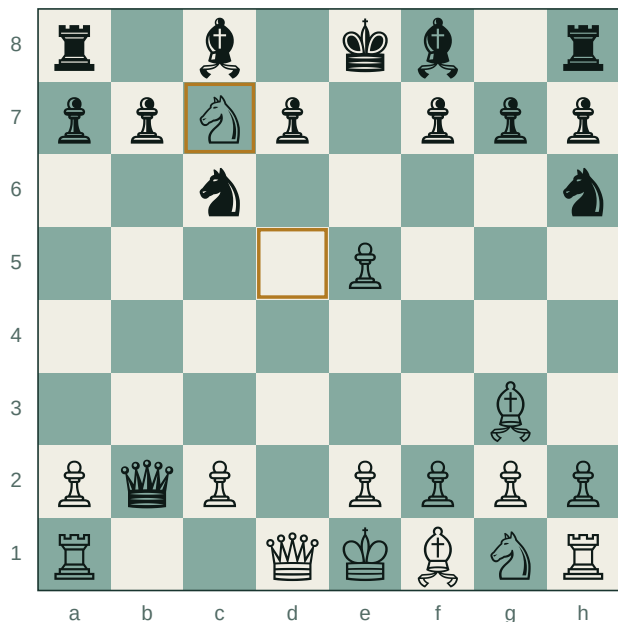


Deflection tactics: Black, move 7

Deflection tactics

Black to move



Previous move: 7.Nxc7+. Gold borders mark its start and finish.

WORKED CONTINUATION - COVER THIS SECTION FIRST

7...Kd8 8. Nd5 Bb4+ 9. Nxb4 Qc3+ 10. Qd2 Qxa1+

7...Kd8 The king moves from e8 to d8. Recorded reply: **8.Nd5**.

8...Bb4+ Check restricts White to 4 legal replies here. Recorded reply: **9.Nxb4**.

9...Qc3+ Check restricts White to 1 legal reply here. From c3 it attacks king on e1, rook on a1 and knight on b4. Recorded reply: **10.Qd2**.

10...Qxa1+ Check restricts White to 2 legal replies here. The move also takes the rook on a1.

At the end, nominal material is White 33 / Black 34 (P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9). Over this line, Black's balance changes by +2. Activity and king safety still affect the evaluation.

CHECKPOINT

Using P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9, how much does Black's material balance change over the complete line? **Answer: +2:** the balance goes from -1 to +1. Count promotions and every recapture, not just the first gain.

CARRY THE IDEA INTO YOUR GAMES

A replacement defender or an intermediate check can keep the target safe even after the original defender moves.

WHAT THIS POSITION TEACHES

Deflection distracts a defender from a critical job. Its new square matters less than the fact that it no longer guards the original target.

HOW TO LOOK

Name the defender's job, find a forcing way to divert it, and calculate the move that exploits the abandoned square.

The defending king is on e1. Geometrically undefended: knight on c7 and rook on h1. Check for tactical protection.